



GETTY IMAGES

BRONZE

» PREETHI PAL

Category: Athletics (Women's 100m, 200m T35)

Born with weak legs and an irregular posture, few in her village expected Preethi Pal to even survive. She had to wear callipers from the age of five to 13.

However, she defied expectations and proved her doubters wrong.

Preethi set the tone for India's athletics contingent at the Paris 2024 Paralympics. The 23-year-old from Meerut clinched a bronze medal in the women's 100m T35 event with a personal best time of 14.21 seconds.

The T35 classification is for athletes with coordination impairments such as hypertonia, ataxia, and athetosis.

Not only was this India's first athletics medal at the ongoing edition, but it also marked the first time an Indian stood on the podium for a track event in Paralympic history.

Preethi, who trains in Delhi under coach Gajendra Singh, also won a bronze in the 200m event in the same classification, making her the second woman, after Avani, to win two Paralympic medals at the same edition.



GETTY IMAGES

BRONZE

» RUBINA FRANCIS

Category: Shooting (Women's 10m Air Pistol SH1)

Rubina Francis became the first Indian woman pistol shooter to secure a medal at the Paralympics when she clinched bronze in the women's air pistol SH1 event. This category is for athletes with upper and/or lower limb impairments who can hold their gun without difficulty and shoot from a standing or sitting position.

Hailing from Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh, Rubina was born with leg dysfunction and faced financial constraints when she took up shooting in 2015. She secured her first Paralympic quota at the Lima 2021 World Cup and became India's first female pistol para-shooter at the Tokyo 2020 Paralympics.

Building on her Tokyo success, Rubina continued to excel on the international stage. She won a bronze medal at the Hangzhou 2022 Asian Para Games and followed it up with a string of impressive performances at the 2023 Para Shooting World Cups.

Her winning streak began in Osijek with a silver medal, and she subsequently clinched a bronze in Changwon. Rubina's contributions to team events further solidified her status as a leading para-shooter.